MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 2, Episode 4

"Deny Everything"

Episode 2x04. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 2x04. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Saturday, October 8, 2005, 5:41 AM through Sunday, October 9, 2005, 6:55 AM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 40 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-2x03

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Saturday, October 8, 2005). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Saturday, October 8, 2005)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	26
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	26
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (22.5 weeks pregnant)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Dr. Abraham Lowery	Attending General Surgeon	Jan 9, 1947	58
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern (on medical leave)	Feb 10, 1979	26
Harriet Baker-Fenwick	Amond's mother	Oct 5, 1952	53
Dr. Solomon Fenwick	Amond's stepfather	Mar 21, 1948	57
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Dr. Victor Donohue	Founder, Victor Donohue Foundation	May 30, 1933	72
Lt. Tanisha 'Tee' Rollins	FDNY EMS Lieutenant	Aug 16, 1976	29
Gwendolyn Monroe (on-screen debut)	Alicia's mother; the Gaithers' neighbor	Oct 10, 1951	53
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern (post-call)	Dec 3, 1979	25
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern (post-call)	Oct 25, 1979	25
Malik Ellerbe	Patient: high-voltage electrical injury	Jan 30, 1975	30
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	Fetal Surgeon; Esther's husband	Mar 3, 1971	34
Nadia Ellerbe	Patient: PPROM after fetal surgery	Apr 25, 1977	28
Dr. Camille Toussaint (debut)	Orthopedic Resident (PGY-3), displaced from Tulane	Jul 21, 1976	29
Harbormaster (new)	World's Fair Marina	Apr 4, 1949	56
Dr. Horace Whitlow	Chief of Medicine	Sep 19, 1949	56
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Dr. Bryce Kennerly	Surgical Intern (medicine consults)	Jun 11, 1978	27
Pearl Gaither (new)	Patient: carbon monoxide poisoning	Apr 12, 1934	71
Rhonda Gaither (new)	Pearl's daughter; patient	Mar 5, 1971	34
Jayla Gaither (new)	Patient, age 6	May 14, 1999	6
Curtis Lemieux	Patient: heart transplant	Apr 9, 1961	44
Odile Lemieux	Curtis's mother	Mar 19, 1936	69
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	42

Also appearing: an NYPD officer, FDNY paramedics including Andre Fontaine, Marcus Gaither (9), an L&D; nurse and charge nurse, a SICU nurse, Victor's driver and Monty's patrons. Mentioned: Councilman Leroy Comrie's office, Dr. Leonard Baker (in a photograph), Joan Mercer, Judge Kittredge and his wife, and Dr. Hampton.

COLD OPEN

1 EXT. GANTRY PLAZA STATE PARK - RIVERFRONT PROMENADE - DAWN

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 5:41 AM

Rain. Not a drizzle: a wall of it, slanting in off the East River in gray sheets. The promenade is empty. The Pepsi-Cola sign is a smear of red through the water. Manhattan is gone, erased by weather.

And one runner: Marc (26), soaked through, his hoodie black with water, running into the wind anyway.

MARC (V.O.)
Denial gets a bad name in medicine.

He reaches the end of the pier. Stops. Rain runs off his face like he's standing under a faucet. He doesn't wipe it away.

MARC (V.O.)
It's the first stage of grief. The thing patients do before they're ready to hear the diagnosis.

A cop in a yellow slicker, sheltering under the park's pavilion, calls out to him.

NYPD OFFICER
(shouting over the rain)
Hey! Buddy! You know there's a flood watch?

MARC
(shouting back, grinning)
I'm fine!

NYPD OFFICER
(shaking his head)
That's what they all say!

MARC (V.O.)
But every surgeon I know is fluent in it.

2 INT. THE CLARENCE - CABIN - DAWN
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 5:49 AM

Flushing Bay. Rain drums on the cabin roof like gunfire. A steady drip comes through a seam above the V-berth into a saucepan. Another into a coffee mug. A third into a bucket. Esther (26), in a hooded sweatshirt and rain boots, empties the saucepan out the companionway hatch and puts it back.

Under the floorboards, the bilge pump hums and clicks, hums and clicks.

Her RAZR buzzes on the galley table. A text.

SMS, from 617-555-0144: "Flood watch for Queens until Monday. The marina will be underwater. Come stay at mine. Couch. No conditions. -C"

She looks at it. Looks at the three containers catching water. Types.

SMS, to 617-555-0144: "im fine."

She sends it. A drop of water lands on the back of her neck. She looks up. A fourth leak.

MARC (V.O.)
We say "I'm fine" the way other people say "amen." (beat) It doesn't mean we are. It just means we're finished discussing it.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

3 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - THE BOARD - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 6:01 AM

A Saturday skeleton crew. Rain lashes the windows. On the TV in the corner: NY1. "SUBWAY TERROR THREAT: HEAVY POLICE PRESENCE CONTINUES FOR THIRD DAY" and then "BREAKING: MAJOR EARTHQUAKE IN PAKISTAN, KASHMIR; THOUSANDS FEARED DEAD." Marc comes in soaked, his hair dripping. Harmony (26) throws a towel at him without looking.

Esther comes in a minute later, also soaked, rain boots squeaking. They stand at opposite ends of the Board. Harmony hands her a towel too.

Elxa (28), twenty-two and a half weeks pregnant, comes in with a massive umbrella, a cup of ginger tea and the face of a woman who has been told to stay home and is ignoring it.

ELXA
Morning. Weekend schedule. And a monsoon. (beat) Policy 4.12 says certain people can't be on the same service. Policy 4.12 never met a nor'easter. (beat) But I'm going to honor it anyway, because my mother reads the call schedule. (beat) Bullock, Divine: the Pit with me. The rain's going to fill it by noon. Car crashes, falls, generators in basements. (beat) Smilley: Graves's weekend consults and the surgical floor.

ESTHER
(quietly)
Yes, Dr. Bullock.

ELXA
Ellison and Cummings are post-call and gone home. Baker is being discharged and is not, under any circumstances, to set foot in this hospital as a doctor for three weeks. (beat) If you see him in scrubs, tackle him.

MARC
(drying his hair)
He's moving into my house this morning.

ELXA
(beat)
Then you're in charge of tackling him.

Elxa winces and puts a hand on the side of her belly. A tightening. She breathes through it and keeps talking.

HARMONY
(watching her)
Dr. Bullock. Are you okay?

ELXA
(instantly)
I'm fine. (beat) Go.

4 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - ROOM 621 - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 6:32 AM

Amond (26), post-op day four, sits on the edge of the bed fully dressed in jeans and a gray V-neck, a drain removed, his discharge papers in hand. Lowery (58) reads them over. Harriet Baker-Fenwick (53) stands at the window in a Burberry trench coat, holding a wheelchair handle. Solomon Fenwick (57) holds three bags.

LOWERY
Tolerating a soft diet. Bowel function back. Staples out in ten days. No lifting over ten pounds for six weeks. (beat) No call, no OR, no hospital, no heroics. (beat) Sign.

Amond signs.

HARRIET
(rolling the wheelchair forward)
Sit.

AMOND
I don't need a wheelchair, Mom.

HARRIET
It's hospital policy.

AMOND
I work here. I know the policy.
The policy says...

LOWERY
(dry, not looking up)
The policy says sit in the chair, son.

Amond glares at both of them. Then he sits in the wheelchair with the dignity of a deposed king.

SOLOMON
(gently)
I brought you an umbrella, Amond.
It's raining.

AMOND
(beat)
I noticed, Solomon. (beat) Thank you.

Solomon blinks. In seventeen years, that's the first "thank you" Amond has ever said to him. Harriet notices too. She pushes the chair out the door without a word, but her eyes are shining.

5 INT. NATASHA AND ROBERT'S BROWNSTONE - RIVERSIDE DRIVE - KITCHEN - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 7:05 AM

Rain streams down the windows over the Hudson. Natasha (47), in a robe, makes coffee. The doorbell rings. She frowns, goes to the door and opens it.

DR. VICTOR DONOHUE (72), tall, silver-haired, in a camel overcoat beaded with rain, stands on the stoop under an umbrella held by a young DRIVER. Behind him, a black Mercedes idles at the curb.

NATASHA
(stunned)
Daddy. (beat) It's seven in the morning. It's a hurricane.

VICTOR
(stepping in, kissing her cheek)
It's a nor'easter, Tasha. I've driven through worse to see patients. (beat) I left Brookline at three.

He hands his coat to her as if it were 1965 and she were seven. She takes it.

NATASHA
Why are you here?

VICTOR
(walking into the kitchen, sitting at the island like he owns it, which, technically, he does)
Horace Whitlow.

Natasha closes her eyes.

NATASHA
Who told you?

VICTOR
Evangeline Truitt called me on Monday. Franklin Bassett called me on Wednesday. (beat) And Judge Kittredge's wife called my wife on Thursday to ask whether I'd be "making a gift" before the vote. (beat) So. Everybody told me but you.

NATASHA
(pouring him coffee)
Because I knew you'd come. (beat) And I knew you'd want to call the Judge.

VICTOR
(taking the coffee)
I'd like to call the Judge.

NATASHA
(firm)
No.

Victor looks at his daughter over his cup.

NATASHA
If you call Kittredge, Daddy, Horace wins. Even if he loses the vote. (beat) The story becomes "Victor Donohue leaned on the board to protect something at Queens Grace." And every reporter in New York starts looking for the something.

VICTOR
(beat)
And the something is my grandson.

NATASHA
The something is your grandson.

A long silence. The rain hammers the glass.

VICTOR
(quietly)
Did you know Horace Whitlow applied to be a Mercer Scholar? (beat) In 1974. Penn, top of his class. Brilliant. Your mother and I interviewed him in the library at Brookline.

NATASHA
(slowly)
No.

VICTOR
(beat)
We turned him down. (beat) Joan said he spent the whole interview looking at the paintings and not at us. (beat) She said, "That boy wants the house, Victor. Not the work."

Natasha sets down the coffee pot.

NATASHA
(very quietly)
Thirty-one years.

VICTOR
(sipping)
Some men hold grudges, Tasha. (beat) Horace builds them. Brick by brick.

6 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 1 AND 2 - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 7:21 AM

The doors bang open, letting in a gust of rain. TEE ROLLINS (29), streaming water, rolls in a stretcher. Behind her, Andre Fontaine with a second. Behind them, a third stretcher with another crew. Four patients from one address.

TEE
Carbon monoxide! Basement apartment, 194th Street, Hollis. Power went out at two a.m. The landlord put a gas generator in the boiler room with the door shut. (beat) Grandmother: Pearl Gaither, seventy-one, unresponsive at the scene, GCS eight. Mother: Rhonda, thirty-four, confused, vomiting. Two kids: Marcus, nine, Jayla, six. Headaches, drowsy. (beat) Neighbor found them. She's right behind us.

Elxa, Marc and Harmony move. Gloria (53) slaps non-rebreather masks on everyone.

ELXA
A hundred percent oxygen on all of them. Co-oximetry on everybody. (beat) Pulse ox will lie to you. It reads carboxyhemoglobin as oxygen.

MARC
(at Pearl's side, checking her)
Her sat says ninety-eight percent. (beat) She's unconscious.

ELXA
That's the lie. (beat) Gas!

Through the doors, wet to the skin, in a long black abaya and a soaked hijab, comes a small, determined woman: GWENDOLYN MONROE (53). She sees Harmony and stops dead.

GWENDOLYN
(stunned)
Harmony?

HARMONY
(looking up, shocked)
Mrs. Monroe.

GWENDOLYN
(rushing to Pearl's gurney)
Pearl's my neighbor. Thirty years. (beat) Rhonda called me at five-fifteen, slurring. Said she couldn't wake her mama. I ran over in my nightgown. (beat) Harmony, is Pearl going to...?

Harmony takes the older woman's wet hands.

HARMONY
(steady)
We've got her, Mrs. Monroe. (beat) We've got all of them.

ELXA
(reading the gas)
Grandmother's carboxyhemoglobin is forty-one percent. Mother's twenty-eight. (beat) The boy's twenty-four. The girl's nineteen.

MARC
(beat)
Forty-one with loss of consciousness. (beat) She needs hyperbaric.

ELXA
(nodding)
So does Mom, and maybe the kids. (to Gloria) Call the nearest twenty-four-hour chamber. Tell them four. Tell them one's seventy-one and GCS eight.

GLORIA
(already dialing)
In this rain, the transport's going to be an hour.

ELXA
(beat)
Then she breathes a hundred percent for an hour.

7 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - FRONT HALL AND STAIRS - DAY

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 8:14 AM

The front door opens. Rain. Harriet comes in first, closing an umbrella. Solomon behind her with bags. Then Amond, refusing Solomon's arm, walking very carefully. Raven (25), in pajama pants and a Morehouse sweatshirt, stands at the foot of the stairs holding a mug. Arianna (25), also post-call, in sweats, sits on the bottom step eating cereal out of the box.

RAVEN
(brightly)
Welcome home, Amond!

AMOND
(looking up the stairs)
This isn't home. This is a temporary housing arrangement.

ARIANNA
(chewing)
He's been here four seconds and he's already a joy.

Harriet looks around the front hall. The framed countdown from Kingston's room and Crump's bow tie on the wall. The fantastic couch through the living room doorway. Her eyes narrow, professionally.

HARRIET
(to Raven)
You must be the one who makes gumbo.

RAVEN
(surprised)
Yes, ma'am.

HARRIET
(handing her a foil-covered dish)
I've made macaroni and cheese. (beat) I'll need to see the kitchen.

RAVEN
(taking it)
The kitchen's...

Harriet is already walking toward it. Raven looks at Arianna. Arianna shrugs and eats another handful of cereal.

At the foot of the stairs, Amond puts one hand on the banister and looks up at fifteen steps as if they were Everest.

SOLOMON
(gently)
Amond. Let me...

AMOND
(beat)
I've got it.

He climbs one step. Two. His hand tightens on the banister. Three. Sweat breaks out on his forehead. Four.

On the fifth step he stops, his eyes closed, breathing hard. Arianna puts down the cereal box and stands up. She climbs up beside him without a word and puts his free arm around her shoulders.

AMOND
(eyes closed)
Cummings.

ARIANNA
(taking his weight)
Shut up, Baker. (beat) Ten more.

8 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 3 - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 8:41 AM

The doors burst open again. Rain. FDNY paramedics rush in a stretcher. On it: a big man in a Con Ed lineman's harness, his work gloves still on, the right one blackened and melted into the skin. He's awake, gasping, his whole body twitching. The smell of burned flesh.

PARAMEDIC
Con Ed lineman! Contact with a downed thirteen-thousand-volt feeder on Francis Lewis Boulevard. Thrown from the bucket. Ten-foot fall. (beat) Entry wound right hand, exit left foot. Brief loss of consciousness. V-tach on the monitor in the bus, converted on its own. (beat) Name's Malik Ellerbe. Thirty.

Marc, halfway across the Pit, stops dead.

MARC
(barely)
Malik?

Malik's eyes find Marc's face. He grabs Marc's sleeve with his good hand.

MALIK
(gasping)
Doc. (beat) Nadia. (beat) Don't tell Nadia.

Elxa is already there, cutting the harness.

ELXA
(fast)
Twelve-lead. Continuous telemetry. CK, urine myoglobin, two large-bore lines, lactated Ringer's wide open. Look at that hand: compartments are already tight. (beat) Bullock. You know him?

MARC
(absolutely still)
His wife is upstairs on L&D. Twenty-six weeks and six days. (beat) We took a tumor off their son five days ago and put him back inside her.

Elxa stops cutting for one half-second.

Behind them, the doors from the hospital open. Clayton (34), on weekend call, in scrubs and a white coat, heads toward Trauma 3. He's heard the name over the radio.

CLAYTON
(arriving, seeing Malik)
Christ.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

9 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 3 - CONTINUOUS
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 8:44 AM

The monitor over Malik shows a sinus rhythm with frequent, ugly extra beats. Elxa reads the twelve-lead. Marc holds Malik's good hand. Clayton stands at the foot of the bed.

ELXA
Sinus with frequent PVCs. Nonspecific ST changes. (beat) Electricity goes where it wants, and it went through his heart on its way to his foot. (beat) He's on a monitor for at least twenty-four hours.

MALIK
(gasping)
Don't tell Nadia. (beat) She'll go into labor. Dr. Hartwell said... stress...

CLAYTON
(quietly)
Mr. Ellerbe. (beat) She's going to find out. She'll find out from a nurse, or from the TV, or from the empty chair where you're supposed to be at noon. (beat) Better she finds out from me.

Malik looks at Clayton, then at Marc.

MALIK
(to Marc)
You go with him.

MARC
(beat)
I will.

ELXA
(examining the right forearm)
Forearm's like a rock. Volar and dorsal compartments. The burns don't show you what's cooked inside. (beat) He needs a fasciotomy in the next hour. (to Harmony, who's just arrived from the CO patients) Divine. Page ortho. Whoever's on.

HARMONY
(dialing)
Who's on ortho this weekend?

GLORIA
(from the station, without looking up)
The new one. From Tulane. The loud one.

10 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 6 - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 8:58 AM

Nadia Ellerbe (28), post-op day five, sits up eating oatmeal, watching the rain. She smiles when Clayton and Marc come in. Then she sees their faces. The spoon stops.

NADIA
(immediately)
Where's Malik?

CLAYTON
(sitting on the stool, low, beside her, holding her hand)
Malik is downstairs in the emergency room. He's alive. He's awake. He's talking. (beat) He was hurt at work this morning. An electrical injury. A downed wire on Francis Lewis Boulevard.

Nadia's hand goes to her belly.

NADIA
(barely)
How bad?

MARC
(gently)
He has burns on his right hand and his left foot. The muscles in his forearm are swelling, and the orthopedic surgeon is going to open them up so the swelling doesn't damage the nerves. (beat) And his heart is skipping. We're watching it. (beat) He asked for you, Mrs. Ellerbe. First thing. Before he asked about himself.

Nadia's face crumples. She doesn't cry. She looks at the contraction monitor. A small bump on the paper. Then another.

CLAYTON
(watching the monitor, calm)
Breathe with me. In for four. (beat) You and your son have been through worse than this in the last five days.

NADIA
(breathing)
I want to see him.

CLAYTON
(beat)
You have a fresh hysterotomy and a twenty-six-week baby. You can't go to the Pit.

NADIA
(fierce, through tears)
Then bring the Pit to me.

Clayton and Marc exchange a look over her head.

11 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 3 - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 9:12 AM

The curtain whips back. DR. CAMILLE TOUSSAINT (29), orthopedic resident, big curly hair stuffed into a scrub cap, gold hoop earrings, a Saints wristband on one wrist and a voice that could fill a stadium, sweeps in with a sterile fasciotomy tray under her arm.

CAMILLE
Ortho's here! Somebody said compartments. I love compartments. (seeing the forearm) Oh, baby. Look at you. That's a forearm somebody needs to open up and let breathe.

Harmony, at the head of the bed, stares at her. Camille notices her staring. She grins.

CAMILLE
Hi. Camille Toussaint. PGY-3. Tulane, until the water came. They farmed us out like rescue puppies. Queens Grace got me. (beat) You must be the intern who paged me in a voice like a church choir.

HARMONY
(flustered)
I... Divine. Harmony Divine.

CAMILLE
(opening the tray)
Of course it is. (beat) Divine, come hold this arm like you're about to dance with it. We're going to the OR, but I'm measuring pressures right here first. (to Malik) Mr. Ellerbe, this is going to sting like a jellyfish at Grand Isle.

She inserts a pressure monitor needle into the volar forearm. Reads it.

CAMILLE
Fifty-two. (beat) Normal is under thirty. (beat) We're going upstairs right now, Mr. Ellerbe. (to Harmony, winking) You're scrubbing in, Choir.

Harmony opens her mouth to protest, closes it and follows the gurney. Gloria watches them go.

GLORIA
(to nobody, amused)
Lord. That one's trouble.

12 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - AMBULANCE BAY - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 9:40 AM

Rain, harder than before. A private ambulance waits under the overhang, rear doors open: the hyperbaric transport. Pearl Gaither, still unresponsive, on oxygen, is loaded in. Her daughter Rhonda, the kids and Gwendolyn will follow in a second rig. Harmony, between cases, holds an umbrella over Gwendolyn.

GWENDOLYN
(watching them load Pearl)
Thirty years, Harmony. She brought me a sweet potato pie the day they found Alicia's... (she stops) The day they found what they found.

HARMONY
(quietly)
I remember. (beat) You gave half of it to me.

GWENDOLYN
(beat)
You were twenty-two and you didn't eat for a week. (beat) I made you.

The rig doors close. Gwendolyn turns to Harmony.

GWENDOLYN
Brother Kareem's wife called me Tuesday night. (beat) She said a young doctor quoted Surah al-Baqarah at her husband, in my words, in the Pit, before eight in the morning. (beat) I knew it was you before she said your name.

Harmony looks at the ground. Gwendolyn studies her face.

GWENDOLYN
(gently)
And the tall one. In there. With the dimples. (beat) I saw how you looked at him when he came through the door.

HARMONY
(immediately)
He's my roommate, Mrs. Monroe.

GWENDOLYN
(beat, a sad smile)
Alicia would have teased you something terrible. (beat) "Roommate."

HARMONY
(firm)
He's my roommate. (beat) That's all he is.

GWENDOLYN
(beat, touching her cheek)
All right, baby. (beat) Allah hears the things we don't say too, you know.

She climbs into the second rig. The doors close. Harmony stands in the rain under the overhang, holding the umbrella over nobody.

13 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - FRONT BEDROOM (AMOND'S) - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 10:22 AM

A big, bright second-floor bedroom with a bay window streaming with rain. Amond lies on the bed, exhausted from the stairs, glaring at the ceiling. Solomon sets up a small bookshelf: Braunwald's Heart Disease, Kirklin's Cardiac Surgery, a framed photo of a man in an anesthesiologist's cap, Dr. Leonard Baker. Downstairs, the sound of Harriet reorganizing a kitchen that isn't hers.

SOLOMON
(placing the photo carefully on the nightstand)
There. (beat) Where you can see him.

Amond looks at the photo. Then at Solomon.

AMOND
(beat)
You kept that. (beat) All these years.

SOLOMON
(beat)
Your mother gave it to me in 1991. She said, "Don't ever take this down." (beat) It's been on my desk in Baldwin Hills for fourteen years. (beat) I brought it because I thought he'd want to be here.

A long silence. Rain on the window.

AMOND
(quiet, not looking at him)
I wasn't fair to you. (beat) When I was twelve. (beat) Or after.

SOLOMON
(gently)
You were twelve, son. (beat) And then you were thirteen, and fourteen, and twenty-six. (beat) It's all right. I've got time.

He goes out. Amond turns his head and looks at the photo of his father for a long time.

14 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - FRONT PORCH - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 10:41 AM

Rain pours off the porch roof in a curtain. Raven and Arianna sit on the porch swing in sweatshirts with mugs of coffee, exiled from the kitchen by Harriet.

RAVEN
She alphabetized our spices.

ARIANNA
She threw out my Pop-Tarts. (beat) She said, "These are not food, they're packaging."

RAVEN
(laughing)
She's not wrong.

A beat. The swing creaks. Arianna looks into her coffee.

ARIANNA
(carefully casual)
Ellison. (beat) You want to get dinner sometime?

RAVEN
(beat)
We get dinner all the time. Monty's. The cafeteria. The...

ARIANNA
(still looking into her coffee)
Not with Baker. Not with Bullock. Not at Monty's. (beat) Dinner. Like a person asking another person.

Raven goes very still. The swing stops.

RAVEN
(finally)
Are you asking me on a date, Cummings?

ARIANNA
(beat, flat, terrified)
I'm asking you to dinner. You can call it whatever you want.

A long, long pause.

RAVEN
(looking out at the rain)
I don't date people at work. (beat) It's a rule. My grandma's rule. "Don't eat where you... "

ARIANNA
(fast)
Okay. It's fine. Forget it. (standing) I'm going to go see if Baker needs...

RAVEN
(grabbing her sleeve)
Arianna. (beat) Sit down.

Arianna sits. Raven still won't look at her.

RAVEN
(quietly)
Ask me again when it's not raining.

ARIANNA
(beat)
What does that mean?

RAVEN
(finally looking at her, a small smile)
It means ask me again when it's not raining.

Arianna stares at her. Then she looks up at the porch roof, at the waterfall pouring off it.

ARIANNA
(deadpan)
The weather says Monday.

15 EXT. WORLD'S FAIR MARINA - FLUSHING BAY - DOCK - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 11:15 AM

The marina in a gale. Flushing Bay is gray and churning. Boats heave and slam against their fenders. The floating dock dips and rises. Water sloshes over its edges. The Clarence rides low.

Esther, in a yellow slicker borrowed from someone, stands on deck working a hand pump. Water comes out in gushes. The bilge pump is still running below. It isn't enough. The HARBORMASTER, a grizzled man in a Mets cap, calls to her from the dock.

HARBORMASTER
Doctor! The bay's going to crest at high tide, around eight tonight! (beat) You can't stay aboard!

ESTHER
(pumping)
I'm fine!

HARBORMASTER
You're not fine, young lady!
You're sinking!

Esther stops pumping. Looks down at the deck, at the water pooling around her boots. At her father's name painted on the transom: CLARENCE.

ESTHER
(quietly, to herself)
I'm fine.

She starts pumping again, harder.

16 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PARKING GARAGE - LEVEL 2 - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 11:38 AM

Rain blowing in through the open sides of the garage. Robert (49), coming in for the weekend to check on Curtis, locks his car. Footsteps echo. Whitlow (56), with an umbrella, steps out from between two cars.

WHITLOW
Robert. Terrible weather.

ROBERT
(not stopping)
Horace.

WHITLOW
(falling into step)
I read your CV this week. Fascinating. Howard, Hopkins. And your father, a bus driver in Washington. (beat) Thirty years on the Metrobus.

Robert keeps walking.

WHITLOW
(pleasantly)
There's an intern on your wife's service. From Washington. Six-foot-five. Your height, more or less. (beat) His grandfather, I'm told, also drove a bus in Washington.

Robert stops at the elevator. He presses the button. He doesn't turn around.

WHITLOW
(beat)
Your son, Robert?

A long silence. The elevator cables hum.

ROBERT
(finally, very evenly)
I don't discuss my family with you, Horace.

WHITLOW
(smiling)
That isn't a no.

ROBERT
(turning to face him, calm)
It isn't anything. (beat) It's twelve years of you not being my friend. (beat) Good afternoon.

The elevator doors open. Robert steps in. The doors close between them. Whitlow stands in the wet garage, still smiling.

17 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 6 - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 12:06 PM

Nadia, alone, staring at the rain. She shifts in the bed. Then freezes. She looks down at the sheet, where a warm, spreading wetness is soaking through.

NADIA
(barely)
No.

She hits the call button. Again. Again.

NADIA
(shouting)
Nurse! (beat) NURSE!

A NURSE rushes in, sees the sheet, and hits the wall button.

NURSE
(into the intercom)
Dr. Hartwell to L&D Six. Stat.
(beat) Rupture of membranes.
Twenty-six-six.

Nadia grips the bed rails. Her eyes are wide with terror.

NADIA
(whispering, to her belly)
Not yet. (beat) Not yet, baby.
Not yet.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

18 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 6 - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 12:14 PM

Clayton does a sterile speculum exam. Marc, who ran from the Pit, stands at the head of the bed, holding Nadia's hand. The nurse adjusts the monitors.

CLAYTON
(calm)
Clear fluid pooling. (beat) Nitrazine positive. (beat) Preterm premature rupture of membranes. (beat) Cervix is closed. No contractions on the monitor right now. (beat) Fetal heart rate one-fifty-two.

NADIA
(gripping Marc's hand)
What does that mean?

CLAYTON
It means the bag of water around your son has a leak. (beat) It doesn't mean he's coming today. (beat) Many women with this stay pregnant for days. Sometimes weeks.

MARC
(to Clayton)
Betamethasone. She got the first course before the open fetal, on Monday.

CLAYTON
(nodding)
Then no rescue course yet. Ampicillin and erythromycin for latency. Keep the magnesium for neuroprotection. (beat) Temperature every four hours. Any fever, any uterine tenderness, we deliver.

NADIA
(to Marc, desperate)
Is it because of Malik? Did I do this? Because I got upset?

MARC
(firmly)
No. (beat) Mrs. Ellerbe, listen to me. Your uterus was opened five days ago. Membranes rupture after fetal surgery all the time, whether anybody's upset or not. (beat) This is not your fault. (beat) And it's not his.

Nadia closes her eyes, tears leaking out.

NADIA
(whispering)
I want my husband.

19 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 3 - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 12:30 PM

Malik's right forearm, open from wrist to elbow: a long, curving volar fasciotomy. Swollen, pale muscle bulges out of the wound. Camille works fast, confident and loud. Harmony assists.

CAMILLE
Look at that. Flexor digitorum superficialis. Pale but contracting. (she touches it with the Bovie on low and it twitches) See? Alive. Mad, but alive. (beat) Carpal tunnel release, Choir. Then the dorsal side.

HARMONY
(retracting)
Why do you keep calling me Choir?

CAMILLE
(cutting the transverse carpal ligament)
Because you paged me in a voice like Sunday morning at St. Augustine's. (beat) And because "Divine" is too on the nose. Your mama really named you Harmony Divine?

HARMONY
(beat)
My grandmother. I was born on Juneteenth. She said it was a sign.

CAMILLE
(glancing up, grinning)
Of what?

HARMONY
(beat, flustered)
She never said.

CAMILLE
(back to the wound)
Smart woman. (beat) Never tell people what their sign means. Let them find out. (beat) Irrigate.

Harmony irrigates. She's blushing behind her mask and she knows it. Camille knows it too.

CAMILLE
(casually)
So. Choir. (beat) Is there a Mr. Choir?

HARMONY
(too fast)
No.

CAMILLE
(beat)
A Mrs. Choir?

Harmony nearly drops the irrigation bulb.

HARMONY
(beat)
There's... nobody.

CAMILLE
(smiling under her mask)
You're cute when you deny things, Choir. (beat) Dorsal incision.

20 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - NURSES' STATION - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 1:05 PM

Esther, back from the marina, soaked, in a fresh scrub top, writes notes on Graves's weekend consults. Kennerly comes up on his medicine rounds, a coffee in hand.

KENNERLY
(cheerfully)
Smilley. I heard your boat's sinking.

ESTHER
(not looking up)
Who told you that?

KENNERLY
A harbormaster called the hospital switchboard looking for "the doctor on the Clarence." (beat) The operator transferred it to medicine. (beat) To me. (beat) He sounded worried.

Esther looks up at him.

KENNERLY
(sipping coffee)
Funny. Your husband's here. Your... (he waves a hand vaguely) ...whatever Bullock is, is here. And neither of them knows your boat's going down. (beat) That's sad, Smilley. That's really sad.

ESTHER
(evenly)
Is there a consult you need, Dr. Kennerly?

KENNERLY
(beat)
Dr. Whitlow says hi. (beat) He's very interested in everybody's family situations lately. (beat) I told him yours is complicated.

He walks off. Esther watches him go. Then she picks up the phone and dials.

ESTHER
(into the phone)
Harmony? It's Esther. (beat) I'm sorry. I know you're in the OR. Can someone tell her to call me when she's out? (beat) It's about my boat.

21 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL INTENSIVE CARE UNIT - BED 2 - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 2:47 PM

Malik, post-op, his right forearm wrapped in a bulky open fasciotomy dressing, his left foot bandaged, on cardiac telemetry. His urine bag is the color of Coca-Cola: myoglobin. Marc checks the monitor and the urine output.

MARC
CK forty-two thousand. Your muscles are breaking down from the burn and dumping protein into your kidneys. (beat) We're giving you a lot of fluid to wash it through. You're going to pee a lot.

MALIK
(hoarse)
Where's Nadia? (beat) They said something happened. Her water.

MARC
(beat)
Her membranes ruptured at noon. (beat) She's not in labor. The baby's okay. Heart rate one-fifty. (beat) She's on antibiotics and magnesium, and Dr. Hartwell is watching her every minute.

Malik turns his face to the wall.

MALIK
(barely)
I should've stayed home. Con Ed called everybody in for the storm. (beat) She said, "Don't go." (beat) I said, "I'm fine, baby."

MARC
(beat)
Everybody says that. (beat) Mr. Ellerbe. (beat) She wants to see you. She says if she can't come to the Pit, the Pit can come to her.

MALIK
(beat)
I can't walk. They won't let me off the monitor.

Marc looks at the monitor. At the bed's wheels. At the portable telemetry box on the shelf.

MARC
(slowly)
You can't walk. (beat) But beds have wheels.

22 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - CORRIDOR - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 3:20 PM

The L&D doors swing open. Marc pushes a full ICU bed through them: Malik in it, on a portable cardiac monitor, his arm elevated on pillows, his IV pole clamped to the frame. A SICU NURSE pushes from the other end, looking deeply nervous. The L&D charge nurse stares.

L&D CHARGE NURSE
Dr. Bullock. You can't bring a SICU patient onto Labor and Delivery.

MARC
(steering the bed)
He's on telemetry. His nurse is with him. His wife is in Room Six. (beat) He's going to sit next to her for twenty minutes and then I'm taking him back.

L&D CHARGE NURSE
Who authorized this?

The door of Room Six opens. Clayton steps out. He looks at the bed. At Malik. At Marc. A long beat.

CLAYTON
(to the charge nurse, calm)
I did. (beat) Dr. Hartwell, fetal surgery. My patient's blood pressure and her contractions both go down when her husband is in the room. That's a clinical indication. (beat) Write it down.

He holds the door wide. Marc wheels the bed into Room Six and parks it right beside Nadia's.

Nadia sees Malik and sobs. She reaches across the gap between the beds. He reaches back with his good hand. Their fingers find each other.

NADIA
(crying)
You said you were fine.

MALIK
(crying)
I lied.

NADIA
(laughing through tears)
Don't ever do that again.

Clayton and Marc stand side by side in the doorway, watching them.

CLAYTON
(low, not looking at Marc)
Nice rule-breaking, Bullock.

MARC
(low)
You authorized it.

CLAYTON
(beat)
I authorized it after you'd already done it. (beat) There's a difference.

MARC
(beat)
Thank you.

CLAYTON
(beat, still not looking at him)
Your... (he stops) Esther's boat is taking on water. The harbormaster called the switchboard. (beat) I heard from a nurse who heard from Kennerly.

Marc turns his head and looks at Clayton.

MARC
(quietly)
She's your wife, Dr. Hartwell.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Yes. (beat) And she called Harmony, not me.

23 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - BAYS 7 AND 8 - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 3:52 PM

The Gaither family is back from the hyperbaric chamber, settled into adjoining bays in the Pit. Pearl Gaither (71), awake now, on oxygen, sits up. Gwendolyn Monroe sits beside her. Marcus (9) and Jayla (6) share a gurney, watching cartoons. Rhonda (34) sits on the end of it, holding her head. Elxa checks Pearl's neuro exam.

ELXA
Mrs. Gaither. Squeeze my hands. (Pearl squeezes) Follow my finger. (she does) What's today?

PEARL
(hoarse, indignant)
Saturday. October the eighth. And I'm missing my stories.

ELXA
(smiling)
That's a perfect neuro exam, Mrs. Gaither.

RHONDA
(looking at her children, shaking)
The landlord put that generator in the boiler room. With the door shut. (beat) He said, "Don't worry, it's fine." (beat) It was not fine.

GWENDOLYN
(firmly)
I already called the city. And Councilman Comrie's office. And a lawyer from my masjid. (beat) That man is going to learn what "fine" means.

Jayla, on the gurney, tugs on Elxa's sleeve.

JAYLA
(curious, pointing at her belly)
Is there a baby in there?

ELXA
(smiling)
There is.

JAYLA
Is it a boy or a girl?

ELXA
(beat)
I don't know. My husband knows. It's in a sealed card in his wallet. (beat) I'm waiting till February.

JAYLA
(scandalized)
Why?

ELXA
(beat)
Because some things are better when you don't know them yet.

Rhonda laughs, for the first time all day.

24 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 3 - SCRUB ROOM - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 4:08 PM

Camille and Harmony at the sinks after a second look at Malik's fasciotomy. Camille scrubs with the vigor of a woman scouring a pot.

CAMILLE
So. Choir. (beat) I've been in New York for nineteen days. I live in a sublet in Jackson Heights with a cat that hates me and a radiator that sings. (beat) Where does a girl go for a drink around here?

HARMONY
(carefully)
Monty's. On Jackson Avenue. (beat) Everybody goes to Monty's.

CAMILLE
(drying her hands)
Everybody. (beat) Are you everybody?

HARMONY
(beat)
Tonight I'm... we're... my roommates and I are going to be at a marina, actually. Bailing out a boat.

CAMILLE
(delighted)
A boat. In a nor'easter. (beat) You're either very brave or very dumb, Choir.

HARMONY
(beat)
It's a friend's boat.

CAMILLE
(tossing the paper towel)
After the boat, then. (beat) Monty's. I'll be the loud one.

She goes. Harmony stands at the sink, water still running, staring at the door.

HARMONY
(to herself)
You're always the loud one.

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC CARE UNIT - BED 6 - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 4:31 PM

Curtis Lemieux, on day five of steroids, his face puffed into a moon, sits in a chair by the window, fully dressed, his trombone case on his lap. Odile is packing a bag. Robert reads the overnight labs.

ROBERT
Today's biopsy is grade one-A. Mild. The rejection's resolving. (beat) If Monday looks the same, you go home Monday, Mr. Lemieux.

CURTIS
(stroking the trombone case)
Home. (beat) I don't have a home, Doc. My apartment in Harlem's a fifth-floor walk-up, and my house in the Lower Nine is a slab.

ODILE
(folding a sweater)
You have a home. I found a two-bedroom on the ground floor on 141st Street. (beat) I signed the lease on Thursday.

CURTIS
(staring at her)
Mama. You live in New Orleans.

ODILE
(zipping the bag)
I lived in New Orleans. (beat) New Orleans is under water, baby, and you're here with a borrowed heart. (beat) I'm sixty-nine years old. I go where my children are.

ROBERT
(beat, quietly)
That's a good reason to move, Mrs. Lemieux.

ODILE
(to Robert)
Tell the baby doctor. (beat) Tell him I'm staying. He'll need somebody to bring him fig preserves.

26 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - TRIAGE ROOM 2 - DAY
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 4:52 PM

Elxa, on a triage bed, scrub top pulled up over her belly, a contraction monitor strapped on. She is furious about

it. Clayton reads the strip. A nurse stands by.

ELXA
This is ridiculous. They're Braxton-Hicks. I'm twenty-two and a half weeks. I've been on my feet for eleven hours.

CLAYTON
(reading)
Four in the last hour. Irregular. Painless. (beat) You're right. Braxton-Hicks. (beat) I'd still like to check your cervix.

ELXA
(beat)
I have an OB. Dr. Hampton. At Jamaica Hospital.

CLAYTON
And she isn't here, and I am. (beat) Dr. Bullock. Thirty seconds of ultrasound, and you can go back to pretending you're not pregnant.

Elxa glares at him. Then, grudgingly, nods. Clayton runs a transvaginal probe; the nurse holds up a sheet for privacy. He studies the screen.

CLAYTON
(calm)
Cervical length four point one centimeters. Long and closed. No funneling. (beat) It's fine. You're fine. (beat) Drink a liter of water and go home. Not back to the Pit. Home.

ELXA
(sitting up, pulling down her scrub top)
I'm fine. I'm going back to the Pit.

CLAYTON
(dry)
Of course you are. (beat, peeling off his gloves) Everyone in your family says that.

Elxa stops, halfway off the bed.

ELXA
(very evenly)
My family?

CLAYTON
(pleasantly, not looking at her, writing on the chart)
The Chief says "I'm fine." Bullock says "I'm fine." You say "I'm fine." (beat) Same cadence. Same chin. (beat) I've been here a month, Dr. Bullock. I listen for a living. (beat) Every fetal surgeon learns to hear a heartbeat through a wall.

A long, dangerous silence.

ELXA
(finally, standing)
Dr. Hartwell. (beat) Bullock's a common name.

CLAYTON
(looking up at her at last, a small smile)
So I keep hearing. (beat) Drink the water.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

27 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 5:34 PM

The kitchen is unrecognizable: Harriet has relabeled every jar. Raven and Arianna are eating Harriet's macaroni and cheese standing up, guiltily, because it's the best they've ever had. Harmony comes in from her shift, still in scrubs, checking her phone. Marc comes in right behind her.

HARMONY
(reading)
Esther called the OR desk at one. (beat) Her boat. The harbormaster says the bay crests at high tide, at eight. The bilge pump can't keep up.

RAVEN
(mouth full)
Her boat's sinking?

HARMONY
(beat)
She called me, not... anybody else.

She doesn't look at Marc. Marc doesn't look at her. He looks at the rain on the window.

ARIANNA
(putting down her fork)
So we go.

RAVEN
We go?

ARIANNA
(shrugging)
She's an idiot. She's our idiot. (beat) I grew up in Gary, Indiana. I've bailed out a basement with a mixing bowl.

Everyone looks at Marc.

MARC
(beat)
Monty has a sump pump in his basement. A big one. He used it during the blackout in '03.

RAVEN
(beat)
Are you coming?

MARC
(beat, picking up his keys)
I'm getting the pump. (beat) It's a boat, Rave. Nobody should lose their father's boat in a storm.

From upstairs, Amond's voice:

AMOND (O.S.)
(shouting down)
I'm coming too!

HARRIET (O.S.)
(from somewhere upstairs)
YOU ARE NOT.

28 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BASEMENT - NIGHT
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 6:07 PM

A low basement full of beer kegs and old Mets banners. Monty (42) wrestles a heavy orange sump pump and a coil of hose out from behind a stack of chairs. Marc takes the other end.

MONTY
(grunting)
Two thousand gallons an hour. Saved my whole bar in August of '03. (beat) Where's it going?

MARC
(beat)
World's Fair Marina.

MONTY
(stopping, looking at him)
The boat.

MARC
The boat.

Monty looks at him for a long moment. Then he hands him the extension cord.

MONTY
(quietly)
Doc. (beat) Go save her boat. (beat) Don't go save her.

MARC
(beat)
That's what I'm doing, Monty.

MONTY
(beat)
No, son. That's what you're telling yourself you're doing. (beat) I've been tending bar for twenty years. I know the difference by the way a man holds his keys.

Marc looks down at his keys, clenched in his fist. He loosens his grip.

MONTY
(picking up the pump)
My birthday's Monday. (beat) Forty-three. (beat) Bring the pump back by then, and we're even.

29 EXT. WORLD'S FAIR MARINA - FLUSHING BAY - DOCK - NIGHT

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 6:51 PM

Floodlights. Rain sideways in the wind. The bay slapping over the dock. The Clarence sits low and listing. Esther, in the yellow slicker, still at the hand pump, exhausted, her arms shaking.

Headlights swing across the dock. Car doors slam. Through the rain come Harmony, Raven and Arianna, in sweatshirts and rain jackets, carrying buckets and a mixing bowl. Behind them, Marc, carrying one end of Monty's orange pump, the hose coiled over his shoulder.

Esther stops pumping. She stares at them.

ESTHER
(barely audible over the rain)
What are you...?

ARIANNA
(climbing aboard, handing her a bucket)
Shut up, Smilley. Bail.

Raven goes below with a bucket. Harmony starts on the cockpit. Marc drops the pump's intake hose through the hatch into the bilge and runs the outflow over the side. He looks at the dock: an outlet on a post, under a plastic cover. He plugs in.

The pump roars. A fat stream of bay water shoots out over the side.

RAVEN
(from below, shouting)
IT'S WORKING!

Esther looks at Marc. He doesn't look at her. He adjusts the hose. They work side by side: Esther at the hand pump, Marc holding the outflow over the rail. No words. The rain. The roar of the pump. Their shoulders an inch apart

and never touching.

MARC (V.O.)
Denial isn't lying. (beat) Lying is telling somebody else something that isn't true.

The waterline on the hull rises, slowly, inch by inch, as the Clarence lightens.

MARC (V.O.)
Denial is telling yourself. (beat) Over and over. Until you almost believe it.

30 EXT. WORLD'S FAIR MARINA - FLUSHING BAY - DOCK - NIGHT
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 7:38 PM

The Clarence floats level now, saved. Everyone is drenched. Arianna sits on the cabin roof wringing out her sweatshirt. Raven and Harmony coil hose. Marc unplugs the pump.

A yellow cab pulls up at the top of the dock. Clayton gets out with an enormous umbrella and walks down the dock. He sees all of them. He sees Marc. A beat.

CLAYTON
(calm)
Es.

ESTHER
(exhausted)
Clayton.

CLAYTON
The harbormaster says the bay crests at eight. You can't sleep aboard tonight. Nobody can. (beat) My sublet's in Brooklyn Heights. Two bedrooms. (beat) The second one's yours. No conditions. I meant it this morning.

Esther looks at him. Then at the others.

HARMONY
(quietly)
You can have our couch, Esther.
The fantastic couch.

Esther looks at Harmony. Then, finally, at Marc. He's standing by the pump, rain running down his face, the hose in his hands. The whole dock waits.

MARC
(evenly, gently)
Whatever you need, Es. (beat)
Wherever you'll actually sleep.

He doesn't say "come with us." He doesn't say "don't go." He said "enough" on Monday, and he meant it. Esther understands that. It's the cruelest kindness she's ever been given.

ESTHER
(beat, to Harmony)
Thank you, Harmony. (beat) But
I'll go with Clayton tonight.
(beat) It's closer to... (she
stops) It's just closer.

She steps off the boat onto the dock. Clayton holds the umbrella over her. They walk up the dock together, toward the cab. Esther doesn't look back.

Marc coils the pump's power cord around his hand and elbow, slowly, precisely, the way he'd coil a suture.

ARIANNA
(from the cabin
roof, softly)
Bullock.

MARC
(not looking up)
I'm fine.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

31 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - NIGHT
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 8:34 PM

The four of them, soaked, in the corner booth, with towels Monty threw at them. The pump sits returned by the bar. On the TV, NY1: "RECORD OCTOBER RAINFALL; FLOODING IN NEW JERSEY, WESTCHESTER" and "PAKISTAN QUAKE: DEATH TOLL PASSES 18,000."

RAVEN
(raising her glass)
To the Clarence. (beat) Saved by four idiots and a sump pump.

ARIANNA
(clinking)
Three idiots. (pointing at Marc) And whatever he is.

The door opens. Rain. Camille Toussaint walks in, shaking out her curls, in a Saints jacket, and scans the room.

CAMILLE
(spotting Harmony, delighted, loud)
CHOIR!

Every head in the bar turns. Harmony slides lower in the booth.

RAVEN
(staring)
Who is that?

HARMONY
(mortified)
Ortho. (beat) The new resident. From Tulane.

Camille squeezes into the booth next to Harmony without being asked.

CAMILLE
(to the table)
Camille Toussaint. I broke bones with your Choir today. Big man, lineman, cooked forearm. (beat) Who are all of you, and why do you look like you've been drowned?

ARIANNA
(deadpan)
We saved a boat.

CAMILLE
(to Harmony)
The friend's boat. (beat) Did the friend say thank you?

HARMONY
(beat)
The friend went home with her husband.

CAMILLE
(beat, looking around the table, reading it instantly)
Oh. (beat, to Monty) Five Abitas, if you have them. (beat) If you don't, five of whatever you have that's closest to Louisiana.

Raven watches Harmony. Harmony is pink to her ears, laughing at something Camille just said. Raven has never seen her laugh like that. Raven looks at Marc. Marc is watching the rain on the window.

32 INT. CLAYTON'S SUBLET - BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 9:16 PM

A tasteful furnished sublet on Remsen Street: bookshelves, a fireplace, a view of the rain on the Promenade. Esther, freshly showered, wrapped in a towel robe and wearing Clayton's old Harvard Medical School sweatshirt, sits on

the couch with a cup of tea. Clayton sits at the other end. Three feet. Like Dr. Greenidge's sofa.

CLAYTON
(quietly)
Your friends came.

ESTHER
(beat)
They came.

CLAYTON
All of them. (beat) In a nor'easter. With a pump from a bar.

ESTHER
(looking into her tea)
Monty's pump.

CLAYTON
(beat)
And he came.

Esther doesn't answer.

CLAYTON
(gently)
He didn't ask you to go with him.

ESTHER
(beat)
He told me "enough." In an elevator. On Monday. (beat) He meant it.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Good for him. (beat) I mean that. (beat) I don't know that I could have done it.

Esther looks at him for the first time.

ESTHER
(quiet)
This doesn't mean anything, Clayton. (beat) Me being here.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Then it doesn't.

A long silence. The fire crackles. Esther puts down the tea. She looks at her husband: the man who held her hand at her father's grave on February eleventh for four years before he betrayed her on the same date.

ESTHER
(barely)
I'm so tired of being angry.

CLAYTON
(beat)
I know.

She slides across the three feet. He doesn't move toward her. She has to close the distance herself. She does. She kisses him: tentatively, then not.

She pulls back. Looks at him.

ESTHER
(whispering)
It doesn't mean anything.

CLAYTON
(whispering)
Okay.

She kisses him again.

33 INT. NATASHA AND ROBERT'S BROWNSTONE - RIVERSIDE DRIVE - DINING ROOM - NIGHT
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 9:58 PM

Dinner for three: Natasha, Robert and Victor, over Robert's short ribs. Rain on the bay window over the Hudson.

ROBERT
(setting down his fork)
Horace caught me in the garage this afternoon. (beat) He asked me if Marc was my son.

Victor's knife stops.

VICTOR
(very still)
And?

ROBERT
I said, "I don't discuss my family with you, Horace."

VICTOR
(beat, nodding)
Good man. (beat) That isn't a lie, and it isn't a door.

NATASHA
(quietly)
He'll find a door eventually, Daddy. (beat) He has Kennerly. He has the CV binder. He has a bus.

VICTOR
(beat)
Then let him find it at the board meeting on the twentieth, with nothing behind it but a family who loves its son. (beat) We are not hiding a crime, Tasha. We're hiding a boy who wanted to be judged on his own hands.

He dabs his mouth with his napkin and stands.

NATASHA
Where are you going?

VICTOR
(buttoning his coat)
Hunters Point. (beat) I drove four hours this morning in a nor'easter, and I haven't seen my grandson's face.

NATASHA
(standing)
Daddy, not like this. Not at that house. He has roommates who...

VICTOR
(gently)
I'm seventy-two years old, Natasha. (beat) I don't wait for "not like this" anymore. I'll stay in the car.

34 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - AMOND'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 10:33 PM

The lamp is on. Amond is propped up in bed, the photo of his father on the nightstand. Harriet's Post-it notes are everywhere: "TAKE YOUR IRON." "WALK 10 MIN 3X DAILY." "CALL YOUR MOTHER." Marc comes in, still damp, and sits on the end of the bed.

AMOND
(not looking up from a cardiac journal)
Arianna texted me. (beat) She went with him.

MARC
(beat)
She went with him.

AMOND
(beat, closing the journal)
Are you okay?

Marc opens his mouth. "I'm fine" is right there. He's said it all day. He looks at the photo of Amond's father on the nightstand.

MARC
(finally)
No.

Amond looks at him. It's the first time today anyone in this house has said it.

MARC
(quietly)
No, Amond. I'm not okay. (beat) I held a hose on her boat for forty minutes, six inches from her, and I didn't say a word. Because I told her "enough," and I meant it. (beat) And then she got in a cab with him. (beat) And it was the right thing for me to do. And it feels like somebody took fifteen centimeters out of me with a stapler.

A long silence. Amond looks down at his own bandaged abdomen.

AMOND
(beat)
I didn't call Dr. Bullock. Monday night. (beat) I sat on the edge of my bathtub with the phone in my hand for twenty minutes and didn't press it. (beat) Because I was fine.

MARC
(beat)
I know.

AMOND
(quiet)
I'm not fine either. (beat) My father died in a car on Stocker Street and I couldn't do anything, and I've spent seventeen years making sure I'd never be the one in the back seat again. (beat) And on Tuesday I was the one on the floor.

Marc reaches over and puts his hand on Amond's shoulder.

AMOND
(beat, not shaking it off)
This doesn't leave the room.

MARC
(beat)
Nothing leaves this room, Amond. (beat) You're my day one.

Amond looks at him. Then he picks the cardiac journal back up and opens it, so he doesn't have to answer. But he doesn't take his shoulder away.

35 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - STREET - NIGHT
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 11:11 PM

Rain, lighter now. A black Mercedes idles at the curb across the street. Marc's phone buzzes as he climbs the stairs. He looks at it: "GRANDDADDY."

VICTOR (V.O.)
(on the phone)
Look out the front window, Marc-Anthony.

Marc goes to the front window. Sees the Mercedes. His face changes.

MARC
(into the phone, low)
Granddaddy. My roommates are...

VICTOR (V.O.)
(gently)
Then come outside. (beat) I've been in this car for an hour. My driver's asleep. (beat) Indulge an old man.

Marc puts the phone away, grabs a hoodie and goes out the front door into the light rain. He crosses the street and gets into the back of the Mercedes.

36 INT. VICTOR'S MERCEDES - 49TH AVENUE - NIGHT
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 11:14 PM

The leather back seat. The DRIVER is asleep up front, his cap over his eyes. Victor (72) sits in his camel coat. Marc slides in beside him, wet. Victor takes his grandson's face in both hands and looks at it for a long moment, the way he did in August at the loading dock.

VICTOR
(quietly)
There it is.

MARC
(beat)
Granddaddy. It's eleven at night. It's a nor'easter.

VICTOR
(letting go)
Your mother said that this morning. You're both very interested in the weather. (beat) Your father told me about Horace. And the garage.

MARC
(beat)
He asked Dad if I was his son.

VICTOR
And your father didn't lie. (beat) And he didn't open a door. (beat) Do you know what Horace is going to do at that board meeting, Marc?

MARC
(beat)
Try to make you the story. And me the reason.

VICTOR
(beat, nodding)
Your grandmother turned him down for a Mercer Scholarship in 1974. He's been waiting thirty-one years to find something in this family he can hold up to the light. (beat) And it may as well be you.

A long silence. Rain on the roof of the car.

MARC
(quietly)
I'm fine, Granddaddy. (beat) Whitlow doesn't scare me.

VICTOR
(beat, almost smiling)
"I'm fine." (beat) You say it exactly like your mother.

MARC
(beat)
Somebody else said that today.

VICTOR
(beat)
Marc-Anthony. (beat) You'll tell the people in that house who you are when you're ready. That's your choice, and I'll defend it with everything I have. (beat) But don't mistake waiting for ready, son. (beat) Sometimes "not yet" is just the polite word for "no."

Marc looks out the rain-streaked window at his own front door.

MARC
(barely)
I know.

Victor pulls him into a hug. Marc lets him.

37 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 8, 2005 - 11:16 PM

The living room lights are off. Raven stands at the front window in her pajamas, a glass of water in her hand, frozen, looking out at the Mercedes across the street. Through its rain-streaked rear window: the silhouette of Marc, and an old man holding him.

Harmony comes down the stairs in her bonnet, sees Raven and joins her at the window.

HARMONY
(whispering)
What are you looking at?

RAVEN
(whispering, not moving)
Marc. (beat) In the back of a Mercedes. (beat) With an old man.

Harmony looks. The dome light in the car goes on for a second as the driver shifts in his sleep. The old man's face is lit: silver hair, a strong jaw, eyes like Marc's.

Harmony goes very still.

HARMONY
(whispering, slowly)
I know him. (beat) That's Dr. Donohue. (beat) From August. The morning Kingston died. (beat) "A friend of the hospital."

RAVEN
(turning to look at her)
A friend of the hospital. (beat) In a Mercedes. On our street. At eleven at night. In a hurricane. (beat) Hugging Marc.

Harmony doesn't answer. Outside, the Mercedes's rear door opens. Marc gets out. The car pulls away down 49th Avenue. Marc stands in the rain watching it go.

RAVEN
(whispering)
Harmony. (beat) Who is Marc?

HARMONY
(beat, barely)
He's Marc.

The front door starts to open. Both women scramble away from the window: Raven into the kitchen, Harmony up the stairs. By the time Marc comes in, the living room is empty and dark.

END OF ACT FIVE

TAG

38 INT. CLAYTON'S SUBLET - BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - BEDROOM - MORNING
SUNDAY, OCTOBER 9, 2005 - 6:42 AM

Gray light through the curtains. The rain has slowed to a drizzle. Clayton sleeps on his side. Esther lies awake beside him in the Harvard sweatshirt, staring at the ceiling. The second bedroom, across the hall, is still made up, its bed untouched.

MARC (V.O.)
Denial isn't the first stage of grief.

She turns her head and looks at her sleeping husband. Then back at the ceiling.

ESTHER
(barely audible, to herself)
It doesn't mean anything.

MARC (V.O.)
It's the last thing standing between us and the truth. (beat)
The last wall.

She closes her eyes. She doesn't believe it either.

39 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 6 - MORNING
SUNDAY, OCTOBER 9, 2005 - 6:50 AM

Nadia sleeps. The fetal monitor beats steadily: 148. A nurse writes on the whiteboard by the door, under "GESTATIONAL AGE": she erases "26w6d" and writes "27w0d."

MARC (V.O.)
And sometimes, if you're lucky, the wall holds just long enough.

40 EXT. GANTRY PLAZA STATE PARK - RIVERFRONT PROMENADE - MORNING
SUNDAY, OCTOBER 9, 2005 - 6:55 AM

Drizzle. The river is high and brown. Marc stands at the end of the pier, not running this time. Just standing. Looking south, down the river, toward Brooklyn.

MARC (V.O.)
Long enough for something to grow behind it.

Behind him, on the promenade, Harmony walks up with two coffees. She hands him one without a word. He takes it. They stand side by side looking at the water.

HARMONY
(finally, quietly)
How are you?

A long beat.

MARC
(honestly)
Not fine.

HARMONY
(beat, nodding)
Me neither.

She doesn't say why. He doesn't ask. Behind them, Manhattan slowly comes out of the clouds.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 2x04

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

THE NEW YORK TIMES: "CITY RAISES ALERT AFTER SUBWAY THREAT"

Friday, October 7, 2005

"Mayor Michael R. Bloomberg said Thursday that the city had received a specific threat against the subway system, and the police flooded stations with officers and began searching bags... Federal officials said the information was of 'doubtful credibility'..."

ASSOCIATED PRESS: "MASSIVE QUAKE STRIKES PAKISTAN, INDIA"

Saturday, October 8, 2005

"ISLAMABAD, Pakistan (AP) -- A magnitude-7.6 earthquake rocked Pakistan, India and Afghanistan on Saturday morning, flattening villages in Pakistani-held Kashmir... Officials feared the death toll could reach the tens of thousands..."

NY1: on-screen chyron

Saturday, October 8, 2005, 8:40 PM

"RECORD OCTOBER RAINFALL: FLOODING IN NEW JERSEY, WESTCHESTER; FLOOD WATCH FOR QUEENS THROUGH MONDAY"

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Saturday, October 8, 2005, 11:58 PM

"Weekend dispatch: a Con Ed lineman with a 13,000-volt injury, a whole Hollis family poisoned by a landlord's generator, and a NEW ORTHO RESIDENT from Tulane who announced herself in the Pit like a brass band. Meanwhile, a certain intern's BOAT nearly sank at World's Fair Marina, and our sources say four other interns and a sump pump from Monty's saved it. Then Boston left with her husband. Under one umbrella. We're just reporting it." Comments (402).

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Esther Smilley and Clayton Hartwell)

Saturday, October 8, 2005, 5:49 AM

Clayton: "Flood watch for Queens until Monday. The marina will be underwater. Come stay at mine. Couch. No conditions. -C"

Esther: "im fine."

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Arianna Cummings to Amond Baker)

Saturday, October 8, 2005, 7:44 PM

Arianna: "boat saved. smilley went w the husband. bullock coiling a cord like its a suture. dont tell him i told u"

Amond: "Understood. Telling him anyway."

Harriet Baker-Fenwick: Post-it notes (Amond's bedroom)

Saturday, October 8, 2005

"TAKE YOUR IRON." "WALK 10 MIN 3X DAILY." "NO LIFTING." "CALL YOUR MOTHER." "YOUR FRIENDS ARE GOOD PEOPLE. LET THEM."

Continuity Sheet: Episode 2x04

New Canon Established

- **Esther and Clayton** (day 27): the Clarence nearly sank at World's Fair Marina. Harmony, Raven, Arianna and Marc saved it with Monty's sump pump (2,000 gallons an hour). Marc: 'Whatever you need, Es,' honoring his 'enough.' **Esther went to Clayton's sublet** (Remsen Street, Brooklyn Heights) and **they slept together**. 'It doesn't mean anything.' The second bedroom was untouched. Esther and Clayton had dinner on Thursday, October 6 (off screen).
- **Raven and Harmony saw Victor** holding Marc in the back of a black Mercedes on 49th Avenue at 11:16 PM. Harmony recognized 'Dr. Donohue, a friend of the hospital' from August 9. Raven: 'Who is Marc?' Harmony: 'He's Marc.' **Both now know something; neither knows what.** This sets up the reveal in 2x09.
- **Clayton suspects Elxa and Marc are siblings and the Chief's children** ('same cadence, same chin'). Elxa: 'Bullock's a common name.' Elxa's cervix is 4.1 cm and closed; she was having Braxton-Hicks at 22.5 weeks.
- **Whitlow confronted Robert** in the parking garage: 'Your son, Robert?' Robert: 'I don't discuss my family with you, Horace' (not a lie, not a door). **Victor revealed:** Whitlow applied to be a Mercer Scholar in 1974 (Penn) and was turned down after an interview with Victor and Joan in the Brookline library. Joan: 'That boy wants the house, Victor. Not the work.' Natasha forbade Victor from calling Judge Kittredge. Victor: 'We're hiding a boy who wanted to be judged on his own hands.' 'Sometimes not yet is just the polite word for no.'
- **Amond moved into the front second-floor bedroom** at the House on 49th Avenue (POD 4; no lifting for six weeks; staples out around October 14). Solomon brought Dr. Leonard Baker's photo, which Harriet gave him in 1991. Amond thanked Solomon for the first time in 17 years and apologized for how he treated him. Amond to Marc: 'I'm not fine either.' Marc: 'You're my day one.'
- **Dr. Camille Toussaint** (Callie Torres counterpart, PGY-3 orthopedics, displaced from Tulane, a Jackson Heights sublet with a cat and a singing radiator) makes her on-screen debut. She did Malik's fasciotomy with Harmony, nicknamed Harmony 'Choir,' asked whether there's a 'Mrs. Choir,' and met the gang at Monty's. This seeds Harmony and Camille (MA-005: their 2006 Vegas ceremony).
- **Arianna asked Raven to dinner.** Raven: 'Ask me again when it's not raining.' The forecast is Monday.
- **Malik Ellerbe** touched a downed 13 kV feeder on Francis Lewis Boulevard: entry right hand, exit left foot, frequent PVCs, CK 42,000 and myoglobinuria. Camille did a volar and dorsal forearm fasciotomy with carpal tunnel release. **Nadia Ellerbe had PPROM at 26w6d** (12:06 PM), treated with latency antibiotics and magnesium, with no rescue steroids yet. She reached 27w0d on October 9. Marc wheeled Malik's ICU bed to L&D;, and Clayton authorized it after the fact.
- **Gwendolyn Monroe** appears on screen for the first time (a Muslim since 1985, Hollis neighbor of the Gaithers for 30 years). She saw how Harmony looks at Marc; Harmony: 'He's my roommate.' 'Allah hears the things we don't say too.'

- **Curtis Lemieux**'s rejection is resolving (grade 1A). Discharge is planned for Monday, October 10. **Odile is moving to New York** and has signed a lease on a ground-floor two-bedroom on West 141st Street.
- **Monty turns 43 on Monday, October 10.** 'Go save her boat. Don't go save her.'

Knowledge Tracker (as of October 9, 2005)

Secret	Who knows	New pressure
Marc's family	Family, Bernie, Graves, Gloria, Mrs. Truitt, Amond, Big Ray, Arianna, Esther	Whitlow (has connected him to Robert); Clayton (suspects the Chief and Elxa); Raven (suspects Elxa)
Marc and Victor	Same	**Raven and Harmony saw Victor hug Marc** on 49th Avenue
Esther slept with Clayton	Esther, Clayton	Marc doesn't know
Harmony's feelings	Raven, Esther, Gwendolyn (guessed)	Camille has entered

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Pearl Gaither	4/12/1934 (71)	CO poisoning, COHb 41%, GCS 8	100% O2; hyperbaric oxygen (off site)	Neuro intact
Rhonda, Marcus and Jayla Gaither	34, 9, 6	CO poisoning, COHb 28%, 24% and 19%	100% O2; hyperbaric for Rhonda	Recovered. Landlord reported
Malik Ellerbe	1/30/1975 (30)	13 kV electrical injury; forearm compartment syndrome; rhabdomyolysis	Volar and dorsal fasciotomy, carpal tunnel release (Camille; Harmony)	SICU telemetry; CK 42,000
Nadia Ellerbe	4/25/1977 (28)	PPROM at 26w6d after open fetal surgery	Ampicillin and erythromycin; magnesium (Clayton; Marc)	27w0d, no labor
Elxa Bullock	8/29/1977 (28)	Braxton-Hicks at 22.5 weeks	TVUS cervical length 4.1 cm (Clayton)	Sent home (didn't go)
Curtis Lemieux	4/9/1961 (44)	Rejection resolving (grade 1A)	Steroids (Robert)	Home Monday

New Characters

- **The Gaithers** of 194th Street, Hollis: **Pearl** (b. April 12, 1934), **Rhonda** (b. March 5, 1971), **Marcus** (b. January 20, 1996) and **Jayla** (b. May 14, 1999).
- **Dr. Camille Toussaint** and **Gwendolyn Monroe** debut on screen (already in MA-005). **The World's Fair Marina harbormaster** (b. 1949).

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- On October 6, 2005, Mayor Bloomberg announced a specific subway threat, and bag searches and police surges followed. The Kashmir earthquake (M7.6) struck at 8:50 AM local time on October 8 (late October 7 in New York), eventually killing more than 80,000. Record October rainfall hit the New York region from about October 7 to 12, 2005, with severe flooding in New

Jersey. Con Edison runs overhead distribution lines in eastern Queens. Councilman Leroy Comrie represented southeast Queens in 2005.

- Medicine: pulse oximetry reads carboxyhemoglobin as oxygenated hemoglobin, so CO-oximetry is required. Hyperbaric oxygen is indicated for loss of consciousness or very high COHb. High-voltage injury causes deep muscle necrosis under small skin wounds, compartment syndrome (pressures over 30 mmHg), rhabdomyolysis and arrhythmias (24-hour telemetry). PPROM management: latency antibiotics (ampicillin and erythromycin), magnesium for neuroprotection under 32 weeks, and delivery for chorioamnionitis. A transvaginal cervical length of 4.1 cm is reassuring.